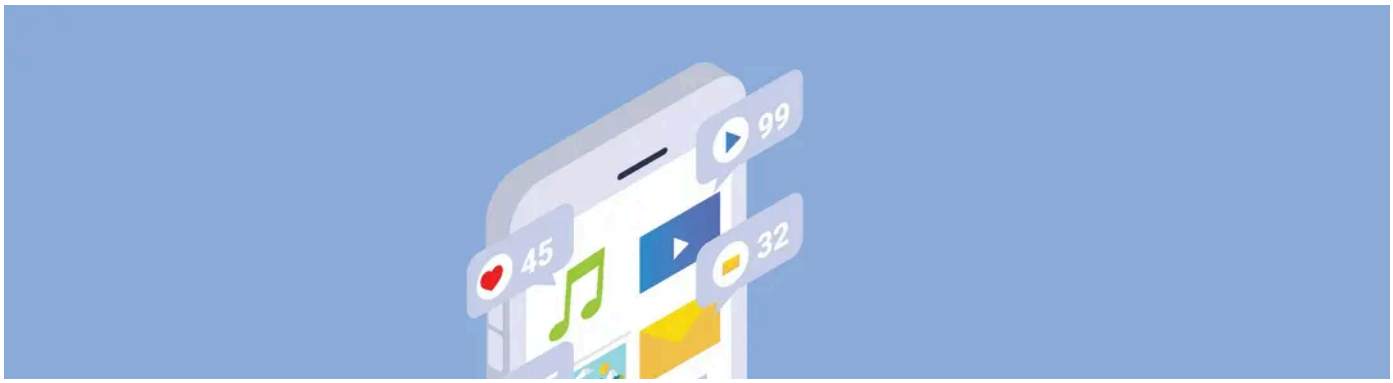
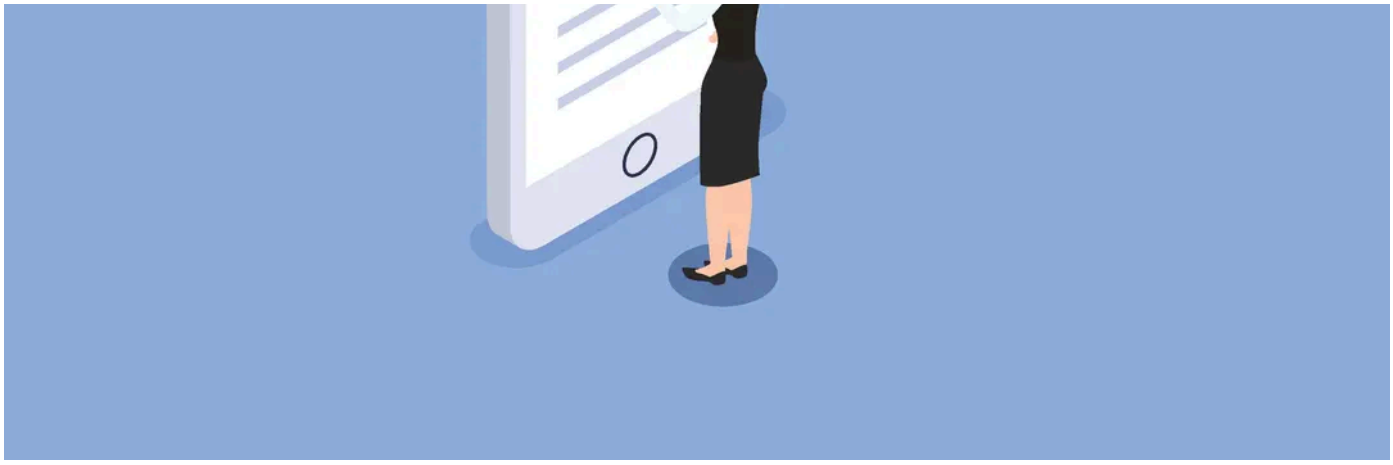
HEALTH + MENTAL HEALTH +

Why Everyone's Worried About Their Attention Span—and How to Improve Yours

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Woman using social media apps on mobile phone. Isometric vector concept *Getty Images*



by Jamie Ducharme

DUCHARME IS A CONTRIBUTOR TO TIME.

AUG 10, 2023 9:27 AM PT

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Seemingly everyone is concerned about concentration these days. Margaret Sibley, a professor of psychiatry and behavioral sciences at the University of Washington School of Medicine, specializes in working with adolescents and adults who have attention-deficit hyperactivity disorder (ADHD). But recently, Sibley says, she and her colleagues have been "inundated" with clients who don't actually have ADHD—they're just worried they do.

It's hard to blame them for worrying. ADHD diagnostic rates are on the rise in the U.S. and posts on TikTok and other social media platforms have convinced even more people that they have attention issues. There's a shortage of medications to treat ADHD, largely driven by rising demand. And even among people who haven't sought medical care, there seems to be a se ns—that focusing i their attention ppening with kids.

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Adam Bro
Bonaventu ew,
inattentio n
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More From TIME

“At a neurological level, I wouldn’t guess there’s this massive thing happening…such that people have shorter attention spans,” Brown says. It’s “the environment we live in. It’s the phones.”

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